

Lucas Wright

Doctoral Candidate, Department of Communication, Cornell University

Ithaca, NY 14850

law323@cornell.edu

lucaswright.net

EDUCATION

- 2026 (expected)** Ph.D., Communication, Cornell University
Committee: J. Nathan Matias, Brooke Duffy, Tarleton Gillespie, Natalie Stroud
- 2023** MS, Communication, Cornell University
- 2018** MSc, Social Science of the Internet, University of Oxford
- 2016** BA, Political Science, American University

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Wright, L.** (2025). The salesforce of safety: Software vendors as infrastructural/professional nodes in the field of online trust and safety. *Platforms & Society*, 2, 29768624251390683. <https://doi.org/10.1177/29768624251390683>
- Wright, L., Muenster, R. M., Vecchione, B., Qu, T., Cai, P., Smith, A., Investigators, C. 2. S., Metcalf, J., & Matias, J. N.** (2024). *Null compliance: NYC local law 144 and the challenges of algorithm accountability*. <https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3630106.3658998>
Paper presented at the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
- Wright, L.** (2022). Automated platform governance through visibility and scale: On the transformational power of automoderator. *Social Media+ Society*, 8(1), 20563051221077020. <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/full/10.1177/20563051221077020>
- Wright, L., Ruths, D., Dillon, K. P., Saleem, H. M., & Benesch, S.** (2017). Vectors for counterspeech on twitter. *Proceedings of the first workshop on abusive language online*, 57–62. <https://aclanthology.org/W17-3009.pdf>

BOOK CHAPTERS

- Wright, L.** (2025). Trust and safety vendors: Looking back and forward. In M. L. Daniel, A. Menking, M. T. Savio, & J. Claffey (Eds.), *Trust, safety, and the internet we share: Multistakeholder insights*. Taylor & Francis. <https://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5360109>

UNDER REVIEW

- Wright, L.** (n.d.). Disinformation, security, and the politics of technification.
- Wright, L., Matias, J. N., Penney, J., Mou, M. E., & Klein, M.** (n.d.). Automated enforcement of copyright law reduces expression online
In second round of revise and resubmit.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- Foster, M. E., Wardle, C., & **Wright, L.** (n.d.). Synthetic researcher dialogs: How LLMs are transforming the role of the researcher in qualitative interview methodologies.

- Wright, L.** & Griffin, R. (n.d.). Professionalization of trust and safety and the construction of risk and security in industry practice
Invited to submit to special issue of Internet Policy Review.
- Wright, L.** & Matias, J. N. (n.d.). Improving engagement with online communities after a temporary ban through value self-affirmations.

SCHOLARLY REPORTS

- Constanza, M. V. B., Candela, J. Q., **Wright, L.**, Bogan, L., & Faddoul, M. (2022). *Technology primer: Social media recommendation algorithms*. Edited by Ariel Higuchi, Amritha Jayanti. Belfer Center for Science, and International Affairs, Harvard Kennedy School. <https://www.belfercenter.org/publication/technology-primer-social-media-recommendation-algorithms>
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). Impact assessment of human-algorithm feedback loops. *Social Science Research Council*. <https://just-tech.ssrc.org/field-reviews/impact-assessment-of-human-algorithm-feedback-loops/>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Grover, R., Waldman, A. E., **Wright, L.**, Elettra, B., & Citron, D. (n.d.). *The political economy of technocratic authority in digital governance*
Panel Proposal Submitted to Association of Law and Political Economy Conference.
- Wright, L.** (2025a). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Denver, USA.
- Wright, L.** (2025b). *Securitization of information: The universal and objective discourse of cognitive security threats*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Denver, USA.
- Wright, L.** (2024). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors*
Paper presented at the Association of Internet Researchers Conference, Sheffield, England.
- Wright, L.**, Muenster, R. M., Vecchione, B., Qu, T., Cai, P., Smith, A., Investigators, C. 2. S., Metcalf, J., & Matias, J. N. (2024). *Null compliance: NYC local law 144 and the challenges of algorithm accountability*. <https://dl.acm.org/doi/pdf/10.1145/3630106.3658998>
Paper presented at the ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Impact assessment of human-algorithm feedback loops*.
Conference on Digital Experimentation @ MIT, Virtual.
- Wright, L.** (2022). *Content moderation as spectacle*
Work in progress presented at the International Communication Association, Paris, France.
- Wright, L.**, Matias, J. N., Mou, M. E., Penney, J., & Klein, M. (2021). *Do automated legal threats reduce freedom of expression online? preliminary results from a natural experiment*
Paper presented at the International Communication Association, Virtual.
- Wright, L.** (2019). *Governing with the AutoModerator bot: A mixed methods study of algorithmic moderation on reddit* [Paper presented at the ICA Rise of Platforms Post Conference, Washington, DC.]
Paper presented at the ICA Rise of Platforms Post Conference, Washington, DC.

INVITED TALKS

- Wright, L.** (2025, December 3). *The salesforce of safety: Software vendors as infrastructural/professional nodes in online trust and safety* [Platform Politics and Policy Seminar Series]. <https://www.wzb.eu/en/events/the-salesforce-of-safety-software-vendors-as-infrastructural-professional-nodes-in-online-trust-and>
- Wright, L.** (2024, November 5). *The political economy of trust and safety vendors* [Ada Lovelace Brown Bag Series].

POLICY REPORTS

- Matias, J. N., Penney, J., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Comments responding to US copyright office notice of inquiry docket no. 2021-10*. <https://osf.io/498ja/>
- Matias, J. N., & **Wright, L.** (2022). *Innovation & governance of adaptive AI with community science*. Submission to the U.S. Office of Science and Technology Policy Research and Development Strategic Plan.

SELECTED MEDIA AND BLOG CONTRIBUTIONS

- Shulruff, T., **Wright, L.**, & Lazarus, J. (2025, July 25). *Online safety depends on a growing trust and safety vendor ecosystem* | *TechPolicy.press* [Tech policy press]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://techpolicy.press/online-safety-depends-on-a-growing-trust-and-safety-vendor-ecosystem>
- Wright, L.** (2019, June 13). *What speech police by David Kaye can teach us about YouTube's latest scandal* [Dangerous speech project]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://www.dangerousspeech.org/libraries/what-speech-police-by-david-kaye-can-teach-us-about-youtubes-latest-scandal>
- Wright, L.** (2017a, March 3). *Google's new 'toxicity' detecting software signals progress in online speech classifiers* [Dangerous speech project]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://www.dangerousspeech.org/libraries/googles-new-toxicity-detecting-software-signals-progress-in-online-speech-classifiers>
- Wright, L.** (2017b, November 10). *Tech can't solve the internet's worst problems—but you can* [Quartz] [Section: Tech & Innovation]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://qz.com/1125563/tech-cant-solve-the-internets-worst-problems-but-you-can>
- Wright, L.**, Karsten, J., & West, D. M. (2016, April 19). *A brief history of u.s. encryption policy* [Brookings institution]. Retrieved August 2, 2025, from <https://www.brookings.edu/articles/a-brief-history-of-u-s-encryption-policy/>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2023	COMPASS Fellow, National Telecommunications and Information Administration, Department of Commerce
2020–	Graduate Research Assistant, Citizens and Technology Lab, Cornell University
2019–2020	Researcher, Global Disinformation Index
2019	Research Consultant, Civic Signals Project, New America Foundation
2018–2019	Graduate Research Assistant, Offensive Internet Project, Oxford Internet Institute
2016–2017	Researcher, Dangerous Speech Project
2016	Research Intern, Center for Technology Innovation, Brookings Institution
2015	Elections Research Assistant, Change.org
2014	National Security and Human Rights Intern, Government Accountability Project

AWARDS AND GRANTS

2025	Finalist - NSF Law and Science Dissertation Grant
2024	Recipient - Cornell Graduate School Research Travel Grant

2024 Recipient - Cornell Qualitative and Interpretive Research Institute Research Grant

2020 Cornell Fellowship (one year of funding)

2016 Inducted into *Phi Beta Kappa*

TEACHING

Spring 2026 Trust and Safety in Online Platforms, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant

Fall 2023 Communication and Technology, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant

Fall 2022 Research Methods in Communication Studies, Cornell University, Sections Instructor

Fall 2021 Oral Communication, Cornell University, Sections Instructor

Spring 2021 New Media and Society, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant

Fall 2020 Media Communication, Cornell University, Teaching Assistant

Spring 2017, 2018, 2019
The Idea of the Internet, Harvard University, Teaching Assistant

Spring 2016, Fall 2015
Laboratory in Leadership Development II, American University,
Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Fall 2015 Individual Freedom vs Authority, American University, Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Spring 2014, Fall 2013
Laboratory in Leadership Development I, American University, Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

SERVICE

Reviewer, Information, Communication, and Society

Reviewer, New Media and Society

Reviewer, Journal of Social Computing

Reviewer, International Communication Association

Reviewer, Association of Internet Researchers

Reviewer, ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency

2022–2023 Treasurer, Cornell Communication Graduate Student Association

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

International Communication Association

Association of Internet Researchers

Association for Computing Machinery

Coalition for Independent Technology Research

Graduate Affiliate, UNC Center for Information, Technology, and Public Life